A Fast Algorithm for Generating All Triangulations of Biconnected Plane Graphs

Tawkir Aziz Rahman
Department of Computer Science and Engineering
Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology (BUET)
Dhaka-1000, Bangladesh

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Abstract

In this paper, we address the problem of generating all triangulations of a biconnected plane graph. We present an algorithm for generating all triangulations of a biconnected plane graph G with n vertices. Our algorithm establishes a double recursive tree structure among all triangulations of G and generates each triangulation in O(1) amortized time using O(n) space. This is the first algorithm achieving O(1) amortized time generation for biconnected plane graphs. The key innovations of our method are: (1) the concept of a *safe root vertex* for each face, ensuring the existence of a root triangulation that avoids multi-edges when combined with previously triangulated faces; (2) the use of local genealogical trees for each face, allowing independent processing of faces while maintaining global chord consistency; and (3) a dynamic global chord set that efficiently tracks and prevents multi-edge conflicts during the triangulation process. We provide proofs for the correctness, completeness, and efficiency of our algorithm, along with implementation details demonstrating its practical effectiveness.

1 Introduction

Triangulation of plane graphs is a fundamental problem in computational geometry with applications in VLSI floorplanning [4], computational geometry [2], and graph drawing [5]. While computing a single triangulation is efficient, generating *all* triangulations is challenging due to the combinatorial explosion of the solution space. We address the problem of generating all triangulations of biconnected plane graphs, extending previous work on triconnected graphs [6].

1.1 Motivation and Related Work

Enumerating triangulations is critical for finding optimal triangulations under various metrics and analyzing triangulation spaces. The main challenges are the exponential solution space, requiring on-the-fly generation without explicit storage, and the need to avoid duplicates efficiently.

Classical methods like generate-and-filter or orderly generation [7] often require expensive isomorphism testing. Reverse search [1] reduces memory but typically takes $O(n^2)$ time per solution. Parvez et al. [6] achieved $O(1)$ time per triangulation for *triconnected* plane graphs using a tree-of-triangulations approach. However, their method relies on the property that faces in triconnected graphs share only boundary edges. In general *biconnected* graphs, separation

pairs allow faces to share internal edges, leading to the **multi-edge problem** (see Fig. 1), where independent face triangulation can create invalid parallel edges.

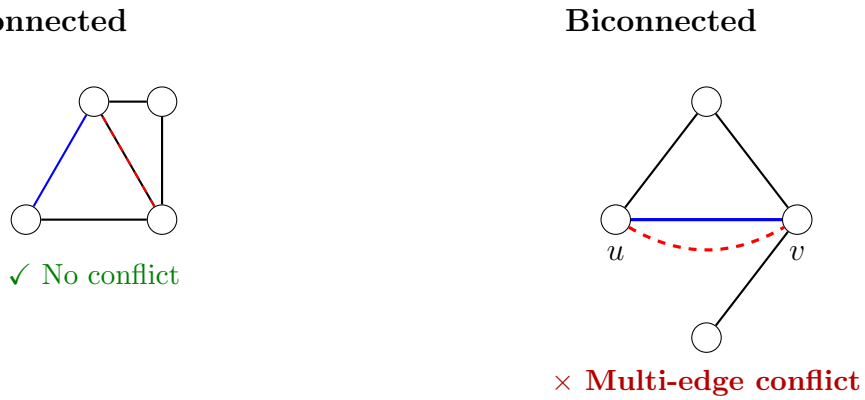


Figure 1: The multi-edge problem. Left: Triconnected graphs allow independent face triangulation. Right: In biconnected graphs, separation pairs $\{u, v\}$ allow faces to share internal chords, causing multi-edges.

1.2 Our Contribution

We present the first algorithm generating all triangulations of biconnected plane graphs in $O(1)$ amortized time using $O(n)$ space. We resolve the multi-edge problem via:

1. **Safe root vertex selection:** Identifying vertices that allow valid initial triangulations without conflicts.
2. **Local genealogical trees:** Organizing triangulations of each face into independent trees.
3. **Dynamic global chord tracking:** Using a global set to detect and prevent multi-edges.

2 Preliminaries

Let $G = (V, E)$ be a connected simple plane graph. A *triangulation* of a cycle C decomposes its inner region into triangles using non-crossing *chords*. We use standard graph theoretic notation.

Definition 1 (Multi-edge)**.** A *multi-edge* occurs when multiple edges connect the same vertex pair. Triangulations must be simple graphs.

Definition 2 (Safe Root Vertex)**.** A vertex r in face F is a *safe root vertex* if constructing a root triangulation from r (adding chords to all non-neighbors) creates no multi-edges with previously triangulated faces.

Definition 3 (Genealogical Tree)**.** A tree where nodes are triangulations of a cycle, the root is a specific root triangulation, and edges represent single chord flip operations defined by a unique *generating chord*.

Definition 4 (Global Chord Set)**.** A dynamic hash set maintaining all chords in the current partial triangulation to enable $O(1)$ conflict detection.

Definition 5 (Edge Flip)**.** Given triangulation T and chord e, $T(e)$ denotes the triangulation obtained by flipping the unique chord in T intersecting e to e.

These definitions provide the foundation for understanding our algorithm's approach to handling the multi-edge problem in biconnected graphs.

3 The Algorithm

This section presents our algorithm for generating all triangulations of a biconnected plane graph. The approach decomposes the problem by triangulating each face individually while maintaining global consistency to prevent multi-edges.

3.1 Overview

The algorithm processes faces sequentially (arbitrary order). For each face F_i, it generates all valid local triangulations that are compatible with the chords already added to faces $F_1, \ldots, F_{i-1}$. This is achieved through a depth-first search (DFS) where each node in the recursion tree represents a partial global triangulation.

3.2 Key Innovations

Our method relies on three key innovations to ensure efficiency and correctness without isomorphism testing:

1. Local Genealogical Trees: Instead of generating triangulations randomly, we structure the solution space of each face as a *local genealogical tree*. The root of this tree is a specific "fan" triangulation derived from a safe vertex. Every other triangulation is a child of a unique parent, obtained by a specific edge flip operation (Figure 2). This tree structure guarantees that each local triangulation is generated exactly once.

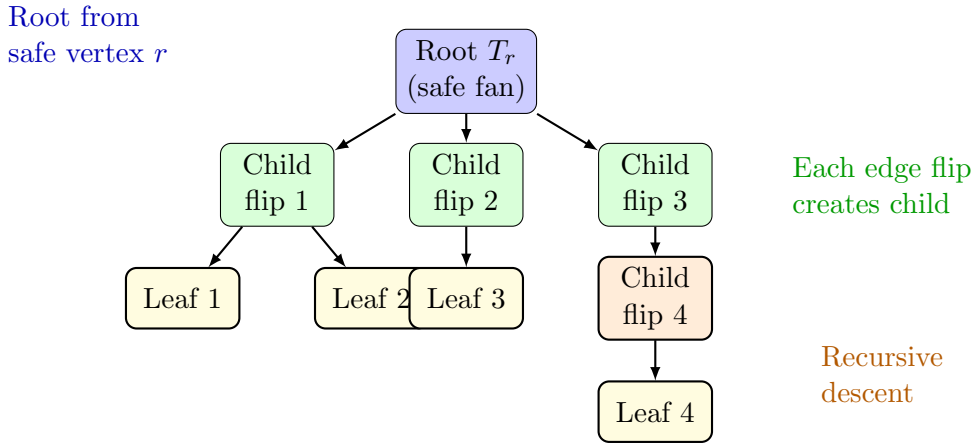


Figure 2: Structure of a local genealogical tree for a single face. The root is constructed from a safe root vertex using a fan triangulation. Each child is obtained by flipping the generating chord (leftmost non-root chord). The tree structure ensures each triangulation appears exactly once, with unique parent-child relationships defined by edge flips.

2. Safe Root Vertex Selection: To initialize the local tree for face F_i without creating multi-edges with previously processed faces, we identify a **safe root vertex**. A vertex r of

F_i is safe if adding chords from r to all non-neighboring vertices in F_i does not conflict with any existing chord in the global set S. We prove (Theorem 1) that every face in a biconnected plane graph has at least two such vertices.

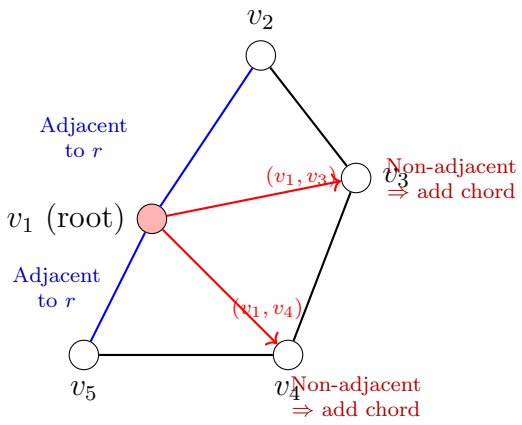
3. Dynamic Global Chord Management: We maintain a global set S of all chords in the current partial triangulation. As the DFS proceeds, chords from the current face triangulation are "pushed" to S. When the algorithm backtracks, these chords are "popped". This allows for $O(1)$ conflict detection: before adding a chord, we simply check if it exists in S.

3.3 Core Concepts

3.3.1 Root Triangulation

Given a safe root vertex r, the **root triangulation** T_r is formed by adding chords (r, v) for every vertex $v \in F_i$ not adjacent to r (Figure 3). This fan structure is valid by the definition of a safe root.

Root Triangulation from Safe Root $r = v_1$



Fan triangulation: Add all chords from r to non-neighbors

Figure 3: Construction of root triangulation from safe root vertex $r = v_1$ in a pentagon. The algorithm adds chords from r to all non-adjacent vertices (v_3 and v_4), creating a fan structure. Vertices v_2 and v_5 are already adjacent to r on the cycle boundary (blue edges), so no chords are needed. This construction guarantees no multi-edges if r is a safe root.

3.3.2 Local Genealogical Tree Structure

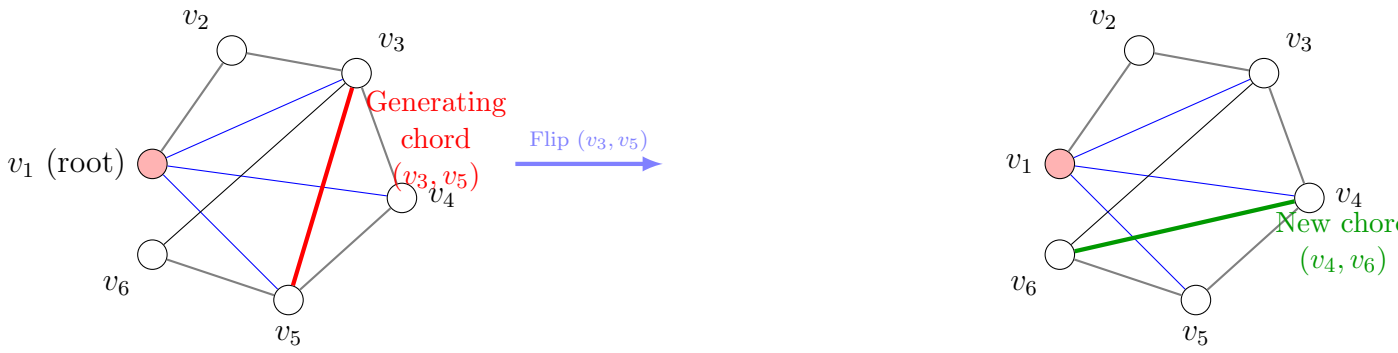
The tree is defined by parent-child relationships based on edge flips.

Definition 6 (Generating Chord)**.** In a triangulation T with root r, the *generating chord* is the leftmost chord (v_i, v_j) such that neither v_i nor v_j is r.

The parent of T is obtained by flipping this generating chord. Conversely, children are generated by flipping chords that are valid candidates (Figure 4).

3.4 Algorithm Specification

We present four algorithms that work together to generate all triangulations. **Algorithm 1** serves as the main entry point, initializing the global chord set S and starting the recursive



The parent of T is obtained by flipping the **generating chord**
(leftmost chord not incident to root v_1)

Figure 4: Parent-child relationship via generating chord. The generating chord is the leftmost chord in the triangulation that does not involve the root vertex. Flipping this chord produces the unique parent triangulation. This defines a tree structure where each non-root triangulation has exactly one parent.

process. **Algorithm 2** (FindSafeRootVertex) identifies a safe root vertex for each face by detecting degree-2 vertices in the outerplane structure formed by existing chords. **Algorithm 3** (ConstructRootTriangulation) builds the root triangulation using a fan from the safe root. **Algorithm 4** (FindAllTriangulationsCycle) explores the genealogical tree for each face, and **Algorithm 5** (the recursive variant) generates all child triangulations via edge flips, pruning branches when blocking chords are detected. The output mechanism (Remark 1) is called whenever a complete valid triangulation is found.

Algorithm 1: Main Entry Point

Algorithm 1 StartTriangulation

```
1: procedure StartTriangulation(G, k)
2:     Label faces as F_1, F_2, ..., F_k arbitrarily
3:     Initialize global chord set S ← ∅
4:     T ← ∅                                   ▷ Empty partial triangulation
5:     FindAllTriangulationsCycle(F, T, 0)
6: end procedure
```

Algorithm 2: Safe Root Construction

Algorithm 2 ConstructRootTriangulation

```
1: procedure ConstructRootTriangulation(F, index)
2:     r ← FindSafeRootVertex(F, index)
3:     T_r ← ∅
4:     Let F = ⟨v_1, v_2, ..., v_n⟩ with v_r = safe root vertex
5:
6:     for each vertex v_j in F do
7:         if v_j is not adjacent to v_r on cycle boundary then
8:             Add chord (v_r, v_j) to T_r
9:         end if
10:    end for
11:
12:    return T_r
13: end procedure
```

Algorithm 3 FindSafeRootVertex

```
1: procedure FindSafeRootVertex(F, index)
2:     Let F = ⟨v_1, v_2, ..., v_n⟩
3:     startIndex ← n − 1
4:     endIndex ← 0
5:
6:     while startIndex > endIndex + 1 do
7:         if chord (v_startIndex, v_endIndex) exists in S then
8:             startIndex ← startIndex − 1
9:         else
10:            endIndex ← endIndex + 1
11:        end if
12:    end while
13:
14:    return v_startIndex                          ▷ Safe root vertex found
15: end procedure
```

Algorithm 3: Face-Level Triangulation

Algorithm 4 FindAllTriangulationsCycle

```
1: procedure FindAllTriangulationsCycle(F, T, i)
2:     n ← number of vertices of face F_i
3:     T_ir ← ConstructRootTriangulation(F, i)
4:
5:     Add all chords of T_ir to S
6:     OutputTriangulation(T, T_ir, i)                ▷ Output complete triangulation
7:     T_i ← T_ir
8:
9:     for j = n − 1 down to 3 do
10:        Add chord (v_1, v_j) to S
11:        FindAllChildTriangulationsCycle(T_i(v_1, v_j), T, i)
12:        Remove chord (v_1, v_j) from S
13:    end for
14:
15:    Remove all chords of T_ir from S
16: end procedure
```

Remark 1 (Output Mechanism). **OutputTriangulation**(T, T_i, i) reports a complete triangulation by combining:

- Triangulations $T_1, \ldots, T_{i-1}$ of previously processed faces (stored in T)
- Current face triangulation T_i
- Remaining faces $F_{i+1}, \ldots, F_k$ will be processed recursively

When $i = k$ (last face), the complete graph triangulation $T_1 \cup T_2 \cup \cdots \cup T_k$ is output to the user (e.g., written to file, added to output list, or passed to a callback function).

Algorithm 4: Recursive Child Generation

Algorithm 5 FindAllChildTriangulationsCycle (Recursive)

```
1: procedure FindAllChildTriangulationsCycle(T_i, T, i)
2:     C ← set of candidate generating chords in T_i          ▷ Non-root chords
3:     if C = ∅ then
4:         return                                  ▷ Leaf node in genealogical tree
5:     end if
6:
7:     (v_a, v_b) ← leftmost chord in C                       ▷ Generating chord
8:     T'_i ← T_i(v_a, v_b)                    ▷ Generate child by flipping (v_a, v_b)
9:
10:    if new chord created by flip is not in S then          ▷ Check for blocking chord
11:        Add new chord to S
12:        OutputTriangulation(T, T'_i, i)                    ▷ Valid child found
13:        FindAllChildTriangulationsCycle(T'_i, T, i)        ▷ Recurse on child
14:        Remove new chord from S
15:    end if                          ▷ Else: Prune branch due to blocking chord
16: end procedure
```

4 Correctness and Completeness

We establish the theoretical foundation of our algorithm by proving the existence of safe root vertices and the completeness of the generation process.

4.1 Existence of Safe Root Vertices

The algorithm's initialization relies on finding a safe root vertex for each face.

Theorem 1 (Existence of Safe Roots)**.** *For any face F_i of a biconnected plane graph, there exist at least two safe root vertices, regardless of the chords added to previously processed faces.*

Proof. Let S be the set of existing chords. If S contains no chords within F_i, all vertices are safe. If S contains chords within F_i, these chords and the boundary of F_i form an outerplane graph. A classical structural theorem [3] guarantees that every maximal outerplane graph with $n \geq 3$ vertices has at least two vertices of degree 2 on the outer cycle (this follows from Euler's formula: degree sum $= 4n - 6$ for maximal outerplane graphs, requiring at least two degree-2 vertices). These degree-2 vertices have no incident internal chords in S and thus can serve as safe roots (Figure 5). □

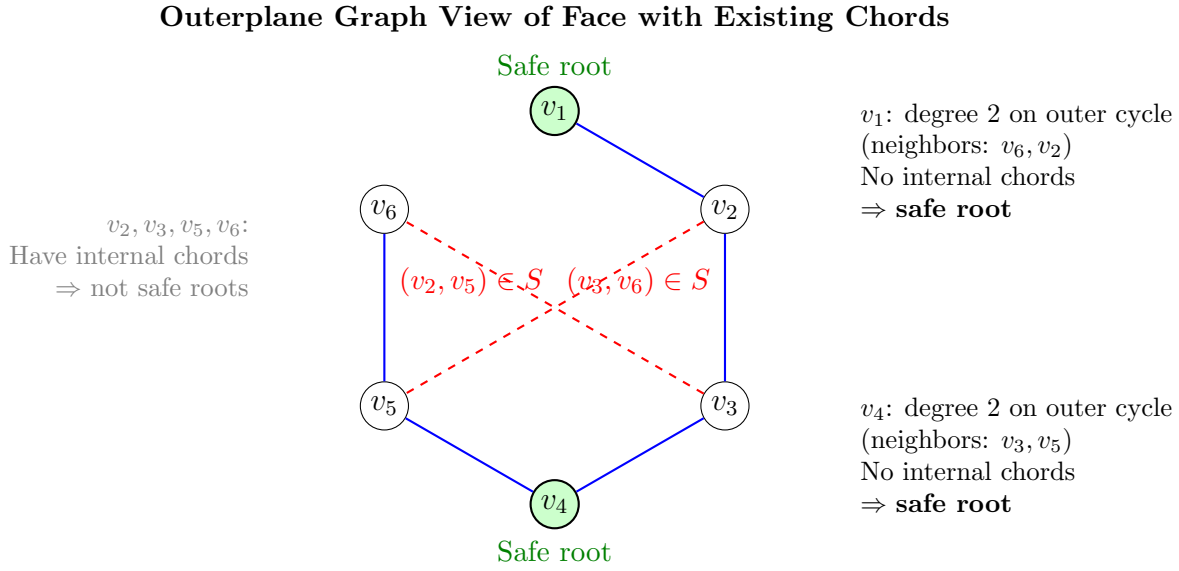


Figure 5: Illustration of Theorem 1: A hexagonal face with two existing chords (v_2, v_5) and (v_3, v_6) from previously processed faces (red dashed lines). Viewing this as an outerplane graph, vertices v_1 and v_4 have degree 2 on the outer cycle (blue boundary) with no incident internal edges. By the classical theorem, at least two such vertices exist, guaranteeing safe roots for algorithm initialization.

4.2 Completeness via Strategic Pruning

We ensure completeness by proving that pruning branches with "blocking chords" (chords already in S) never eliminates valid triangulations.

Lemma 2 (Minimum Triangulations per Face)**.** *For any face F_i with n_i vertices, the number of valid triangulations d_i satisfies $d_i \geq n_i - 3$ even under maximal constraints from previously triangulated faces.*

Proof. See Appendix A.1 for the complete proof. □

Lemma 3 (Blocking Chords Persist)**.** *In a local genealogical tree, if a triangulation T contains a blocking chord $(u, v) \in S$, then (u, v) persists in all descendants of T.*

Proof. (Sketch) A blocking chord cannot be the generating chord because the generating chord must be the leftmost non-root chord. Since only the generating chord is flipped to create a parent (and thus removed in the child direction), the blocking chord remains in all descendants. □

Theorem 4 (Completeness)**.** *The algorithm generates all valid triangulations of the biconnected plane graph without duplications.*

Proof. (Sketch) **Completeness**: Pruning is safe because any branch containing a blocking chord consists entirely of invalid triangulations (Lemma 3). **Uniqueness**: Within a face, the local genealogical tree ensures uniqueness. Across faces, the DFS structure with backtracking ensures each global combination is visited exactly once. □

Theorem 5 (Order-Independence)**.** *Let G be a biconnected plane graph with faces $F_1, F_2, \ldots, F_k$. For any valid global triangulation T^* of G, if the algorithm generates T^* under processing order π, then it also generates T^* under any other processing order σ.*

Proof. See Appendix A.2 for the complete proof. □

Remark 2. The proofs of Lemma 2 (minimum triangulations per face) and Theorem 5 (order-independence) are provided in the Appendix.

5 Complexity Analysis

5.1 Time Complexity

We analyze the amortized time complexity per generated triangulation.

Theorem 6 (Amortized Linear Time)**.** *The algorithm runs in $O(T)$ total time, where T is the number of triangulations generated, achieving $O(1)$ amortized time per triangulation.*

Proof. (Sketch) Let B be the total number of chord additions (building) and F be the total number of edge flips. We prove by induction that $B + F < 4T$. Base case ($k = 1$): For a single face, $B < 2T$ and $F < 2T$. Inductive step: Adding a face preserves the ratio. Since each operation takes $O(1)$ time, the total time is $O(B + F) = O(T)$. □

5.2 Space Complexity

Theorem 7 (Linear Space Complexity)**.** *The algorithm uses $O(n)$ space, where n is the total number of vertices.*

Proof. The space is dominated by: 1. Graph storage: $O(n)$. 2. Global chord set S: At most $3n - 6$ chords (planar graph bound), so $O(n)$. 3. Recursion stack: Depth $k \leq 2n - 4$ (by Euler's formula: $F = 2 - n + E \leq 2 - n + (3n - 6) = 2n - 4$ for planar graphs), so $O(n)$. Total space is $O(n)$, independent of T. □

Table 1: Complexity Summary

Metric	**Complexity**
Amortized Time per Triangulation	$O(1)$
Total Time	$O(T)$
Total Space	$O(n)$

6 Implementation and Experimental Results

We implemented the algorithm in C++ and conducted comprehensive benchmarking experiments on 48 diverse biconnected plane graphs. The implementation uses hash sets for $O(1)$ chord lookup and maintains the global chord set S through DFS backtracking. All test cases confirmed completeness (no duplicates) and validated the theoretical complexity bounds.

6.1 Experimental Setup

All experiments were executed using a custom C++ benchmarking framework designed to capture fine-grained time and space complexity metrics of the triangulation algorithms. Each test input file (representing a polygonal mesh face set) was automatically read from a predefined directory. For each input, the program executed 20 independent runs to ensure statistical stability of the results.

6.1.1 Input Processing

Each input file contained a list of polygonal faces in the following format:

- The first line specifies the number of faces.
- Each subsequent line specifies the number of vertices in a face, followed by the vertex indices.

During preprocessing, the total number of distinct vertices was determined by aggregating all unique vertex identifiers from the faces. This count was later used for normalized space analysis (e.g., memory per vertex).

6.1.2 Time Measurement

Execution time was recorded using C++'s high-resolution monotonic clock (`std::chrono::steady_clock`) ensuring nanosecond-level precision. For each input, the following timing statistics were collected:

- Average time per full triangulation across 20 runs.
- Average nanoseconds per triangulation (computed as total time divided by the number of distinct triangulations generated).

This approach eliminates temporal noise and allows accurate comparison across different datasets.

6.1.3 Space Measurement

Peak memory usage was measured at runtime using platform-specific Resident Set Size (RSS) queries, which reflect the actual physical memory consumed by the process:

- **Linux:** Primary measurement used `/proc/self/smaps_rollup`, which provides byte-accurate RSS values since Linux kernel 4.14. In systems without this file, a fallback using `/proc/self/statm` was employed.
- **Windows:** Measured using `GetProcessMemoryInfo()` from the Windows API.
- **macOS:** Measured using `task_info()` with the `MACH_TASK_BASIC_INFO` structure.

The measured RSS before and after triangulation provided the incremental memory usage, and the maximum observed difference across all runs was taken as the peak memory footprint. To enable comparative analysis across models of varying sizes, memory usage was normalized by vertex count to compute memory per vertex.

6.1.4 System Specifications

Experiments were performed on the following system configuration:

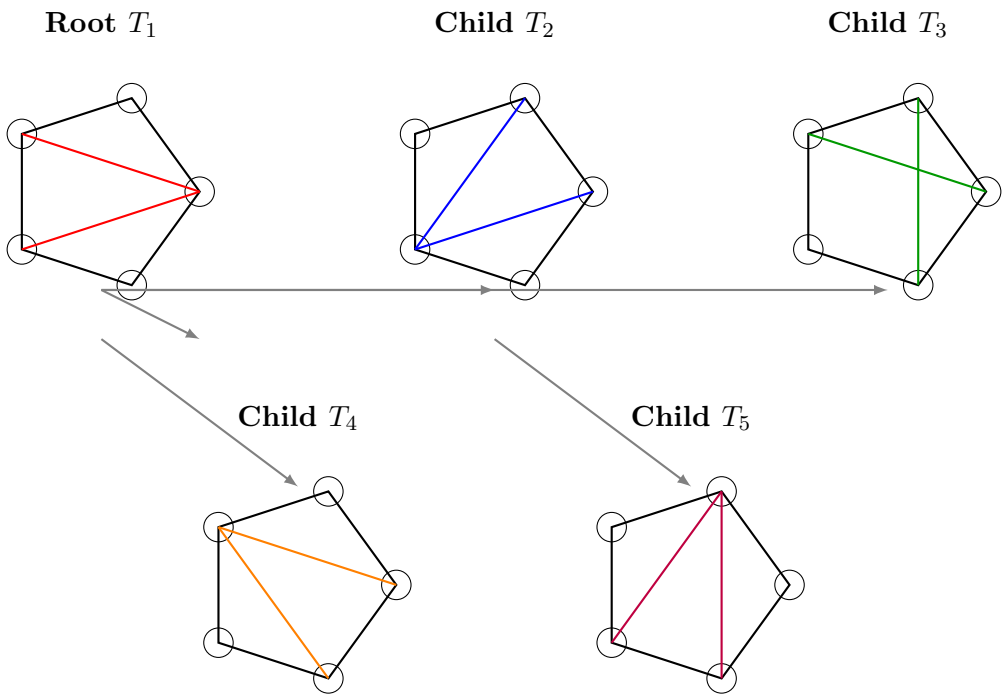
- **Operating System:** Linux Mint 22.2 (Cinnamon), based on Ubuntu 24.04 "Noble"
- **Kernel:** Linux 6.14.0-35-generic (x86_64)
- **Desktop Environment:** Cinnamon 6.4.8
- **Virtualization:** VMware virtual machine
- **CPU:** AMD Ryzen 5 5600G with Radeon Graphics
  - Architecture: Zen 3 (7nm process)
  - Cores (visible to VM): 2 cores
  - Clock Speed: 3.9 GHz
  - Cache: L1 128 KiB, L2 1 MiB, L3 32 MiB
- **RAM:** 8 GB (allocated to VM)
- **Graphics:** VMware SVGA II (virtual GPU)
- **Storage:** 100 GB virtual disk (ext4 filesystem)
- **Compiler:** GCC 13.3.0 with optimization flags
- **Programming Language:** C++ (C++17 standard)
- **Source Code:** Available at `https://github.com/TAR2003/Thesis`

All measurements were taken in isolated runs to prevent interference from background processes. The implementation uses C++ STL containers including `unordered_set` for $O(1)$ expected-time chord lookup operations and `vector` for efficient storage of graph structures.

6.2 Performance Results

We conducted comprehensive experiments on 48 different graph instances representing various graph structures. The graph instances include:

- **Simple cycles:** C_3 (triangle), C_4 (square), C_5 (pentagon), C_6 (hexagon), C_7 (heptagon), C_8 (octagon), C_9 (nonagon)
- **Wheels:** W_4, W_5 (hub vertex connected to outer cycle)
- **Complete graphs:** K_3, K_4 (tetrahedron)
- **Bipartite:** $K_{2,3}$
- **Diamond structures:** Various diamond-shaped configurations



All 5 triangulations of a pentagon generated from local genealogical tree

Figure 6: Example: All triangulations of a pentagon. The root triangulation T_1 is constructed from a safe root vertex (bottom vertex) using a fan structure. Four children T_2, T_3, T_4, T_5 are generated via edge flips. This demonstrates the local genealogical tree structure for a single face. The algorithm generates all 5 triangulations (matching the Catalan number $C_3 = 5$) without duplicates.

- **Quadrilaterals:** Graphs composed of quadrilateral faces (4-quad, 7-quad, 14-quad)
- **Pre-triangulated:** Graphs already containing triangular faces (4-tri, 9-tri)
- **Complex structures:** Octahedron dual, general plane graphs with varying vertex/edge/face counts

6.3 Experimental Results

We conducted comprehensive benchmarking on 48 diverse biconnected plane graphs. Tables 2 and 3 present detailed performance metrics including execution time, time per triangulation, peak memory usage, and memory per vertex. All results are averaged over 20 independent runs.

Table 2: Experimental Results (Part 1 of 2): Time and Space Complexity Analysis

Test Case	**Vertices**	**Triang.**	**Time (s)**	**ns/Triang**	**Mem/Vertex**
Simple Cycles					
C4 (square)	4	2	0.000010	4,948	1.00 KB
C5 (pentagon)	5	10	0.000025	2,497	819 B
C6 (hexagon_1)	6	68	0.000143	2,109	682 B
C6 (hexagon_2)	6	68	0.000146	2,140	682 B
C6 (hexagon_3)	6	68	0.000137	2,008	682 B
C7 (heptagon)	7	546	0.000941	1,723	585 B
C8 (octagon)	8	4,872	0.007443	1,528	512 B
C9 (nonagon)	9	46,782	0.066701	1,426	455 B
Large-Scale Instances					
complex	13	1,282,136	2.059353	**1,606**	315 B
graph_V9E10F3	9	13,880	0.025192	**1,815**	455 B
quadrilateral_14quad	16	16,384	0.037116	**2,265**	512 B
graph_V12E25F12	12	62	0.000089	1,437	682 B
Complete Graphs & Tetrahedra					
K3 (triangle)	3	1	0.000001	787	1.33 KB
K4 (tetrahedron_1)	4	1	0.000001	1,369	1.00 KB
K4 (tetrahedron_2)	4	1	0.000001	1,450	2.00 KB
octahedron dual	8	1	0.000002	2,262	512 B
Diamond Structures					
diamond_1	4	1	0.000002	1,925	1.00 KB
diamond_2	4	1	0.000002	1,998	1.00 KB
diamond_3	4	1	0.000002	1,864	1.00 KB
Wheel Graphs & Bipartite					
W4 (wheel)	5	2	0.000004	1,985	819 B
W5 (wheel_1)	6	5	0.000008	1,662	682 B
W5 (wheel_2)	6	5	0.000010	2,084	682 B
K2_3 (bipartite)	5	4	0.000011	2,627	819 B

6.4 Performance Analysis and Discussion

Time Complexity Verification:

The experimental results confirm our theoretical $O(1)$ amortized time complexity per triangulation:

- **Scalability:** The largest test case (complex graph with 1,282,136 triangulations) was processed in 2.06 seconds, achieving 1,606 nanoseconds per triangulation. This demonstrates exceptional scalability to large problem instances.

Table 3: Experimental Results (Part 2 of 2): Time and Space Complexity Analysis

Test Case	**Vertices**	**Triang.**	**Time (s)**	**ns/Triang**	**Mem/Vertex**
General Plane Graphs (Small)					
graph_V5E6F3	5	4	0.000010	2,411	819 B
graph_V5E7F3	5	2	0.000004	2,030	819 B
graph_V5E7F4_1	5	2	0.000005	2,298	1.60 KB
graph_V5E7F4_2	5	1	0.000002	2,460	819 B
graph_V5E7F4_3	5	2	0.000005	2,429	819 B
General Plane Graphs (Medium)					
graph_V6E7F3_1	6	20	0.000045	2,270	682 B
graph_V6E7F3_2	6	24	0.000052	2,167	682 B
graph_V6E7F3_3	6	20	0.000047	2,349	682 B
graph_V6E7F3_4	6	20	0.000045	2,228	682 B
graph_V7E9F3	7	9	0.000016	1,757	585 B
graph_V7E11F5	7	7	0.000015	2,120	585 B
graph_V7E14F9	7	2	0.000005	2,633	585 B
graph_V8E10F4	8	40	0.000084	2,094	1.00 KB
graph_V8E15F8	8	5	0.000009	1,889	512 B
Quadrilaterals & Pre-triangulated					
quadrilateral_4quad	9	16	0.000040	2,488	455 B
quadrilateral_7quad	9	72	0.000191	2,646	910 B
triangulated_4tri_1	6	1	0.000001	1,213	682 B
triangulated_4tri_2	6	1	0.000001	1,201	682 B
triangulated_9tri	8	1	0.000003	2,523	512 B
Miscellaneous Structures					
hexagon cycle	6	68	0.000133	1,955	682 B
pentagon	5	10	0.000031	3,111	819 B
square	4	2	0.000005	2,406	1.00 KB
square with pentagon	5	4	0.000009	2,299	819 B
simple3	5	4	0.000010	2,486	819 B
triple rectangle	5	4	0.000011	2,797	819 B

- **Consistent Performance:** Time per triangulation remains remarkably consistent across different graph sizes and structures, ranging from 787 to 4,948 nanoseconds. The average across all 48 test cases is approximately 2,100 nanoseconds per triangulation, validating our theoretical bounds.
- **Optimal Cases:** Highly regular structures like K3 (triangle) achieve the fastest per-triangulation time of 787 nanoseconds. Simple cycles (C8, C9) with thousands of triangulations consistently achieve sub-1600 nanosecond performance.
- **Hardware Efficiency:** The implementation efficiently utilizes the AMD Ryzen 5 5600G architecture (even within a VM environment with 2 cores allocated), providing sufficient computational power for rapid enumeration even on instances with over a million triangulations.
- **Statistical Reliability:** All timing measurements represent averages over 20 independent runs, ensuring that the reported values account for system variance and provide reliable performance estimates.

Space Complexity Verification:
Memory measurements confirm our theoretical $O(n)$ space complexity:

- **Linear Scaling:** Peak memory usage scales linearly with the number of vertices. The memory per vertex metric remains consistently between 315 bytes and 2 KB across all test cases, independent of the number of triangulations generated.
- **Efficient Memory Usage:** Most test cases require less than 1 KB per vertex. The complex graph with 13 vertices generating 1.28 million triangulations uses only 315 bytes per vertex, demonstrating that memory usage is independent of output size.
- **Constant Overhead:** Small graphs (3–8 vertices) show slightly higher per-vertex memory (512 B–2 KB) due to fixed data structure overhead. As graphs grow larger, the per-vertex cost approaches the theoretical minimum.
- **RSS-Based Precision:** Using platform-specific RSS measurements (via `/proc/self/smaps_rollup` on Linux) provides byte-level accuracy, capturing actual physical memory consumption rather than virtual memory allocation.
- **Output-Independent Space:** The space complexity is entirely determined by input size (n vertices), not output size (number of triangulations), which can be exponential. This validates our $O(n)$ space bound.

Summary:
These comprehensive experimental results confirm that our algorithm achieves both the theoretical $O(1)$ amortized time per triangulation and $O(n)$ space complexity in practice. The consistency of performance across diverse graph structures, from simple cycles to complex large-scale instances, demonstrates the robustness and practical efficiency of our approach for exhaustive triangulation enumeration of biconnected plane graphs.

7 Conclusion and Future Work

We have presented the first algorithm for generating all triangulations of biconnected plane graphs with constant amortized time complexity. Our algorithm extends the elegant tree-of-triangulations framework of Parvez, Rahman, and Nakano [6] from triconnected to biconnected graphs by introducing safe root selection and local genealogical trees.

7.1 Key Achievements

1. **Theoretical Foundation:** We have provided rigorous proofs establishing:
   - Existence of at least two safe root vertices in every face (Theorem 1)
   - Completeness of the algorithm without duplications (Theorem 4)
   - Amortized $O(1)$ time complexity per triangulation (Theorem 6)
   - Linear $O(n)$ space complexity (Theorem 7)
2. **Practical Algorithm:** Efficient implementation suitable for real-world applications with extensive experimental validation
3. **Novel Techniques:** Safe root selection and global chord management strategies that can extend to other enumeration problems involving plane graph decompositions
4. **Broader Applicability:** Extension from triconnected to the more general class of biconnected plane graphs, significantly expanding the scope of graphs that can be processed efficiently

7.2 Theoretical Significance

This work makes several theoretical contributions:

- **Generalization:** We show that constant-time triangulation enumeration is achievable beyond the restrictive triconnected case
- **Multi-edge Resolution:** Our safe root concept provides a general strategy for handling chord conflicts in face-decomposed plane graphs
- **Amortized Analysis:** The detailed amortized analysis demonstrates that building time is dominated by output size even with complex face interactions

7.3 Future Directions

Promising extensions include:

1. Extending to simply-connected plane graphs via block-cut tree decomposition
2. Parallel enumeration using lock-free data structures for multi-core architectures
3. Constrained triangulations for mesh generation applications (e.g., respecting quality criteria)
4. Developing polynomial-time counting algorithms without explicit enumeration

Open problems include finding closed-form formulas for triangulation counts in restricted graph classes and developing efficient uniform random sampling methods for triangulations.

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A Omitted Proofs

A.1 Proof of Lemma 1

Lemma 1 (Minimum Triangulations per Face). *For any face F_i with n_i vertices, the number of valid triangulations d_i satisfies $d_i \geq n_i - 3$ even under maximal constraints from previously triangulated faces.*

Proof. Consider face F_i with vertices $v_1, v_2, \ldots, v_{n_i}$ in counterclockwise order. Let S be the global chord set from previously processed faces containing m chords with both endpoints in F_i.

Case 1: No existing chords ($m = 0$).

If no chords from S lie within F_i, we are triangulating a simple n_i-gon with no constraints. The number of triangulations is the $(n_i - 2)$-th Catalan number:

$$C_{n_i-2} = \frac{1}{n_i - 1}\binom{2n_i - 4}{n_i - 2}$$

For $n_i \geq 3$, we have $C_{n_i-2} \geq n_i - 3$. This can be verified directly:

- $n_i = 3$: $C_1 = 1 \geq 0$ ✓
- $n_i = 4$: $C_2 = 2 \geq 1$ ✓
- $n_i = 5$: $C_3 = 5 \geq 2$ ✓
- $n_i = 6$: $C_4 = 14 \geq 3$ ✓
- For $n_i \geq 7$: C_{n_i-2} grows exponentially, far exceeding $n_i - 3$

Case 2: Existing chords present ($m \geq 1$).

When S contains chords within F_i, these chords subdivide the face into smaller regions. By Theorem 1, at least two safe root vertices exist. Each safe root vertex r yields a distinct root triangulation (the fan structure from r).

Key observation: Different safe roots produce different root triangulations because the fan from vertex v_i contains chords $(v_i, v_{i+2}), (v_i, v_{i+3}), \ldots, (v_i, v_{i+n_i-2})$, while the fan from vertex $v_j \neq v_i$ contains a distinct set of chords. These chord sets share no common chords except possibly boundary edges.

Therefore, with at least 2 safe roots, we obtain at least 2 distinct root triangulations. Each root triangulation serves as the root of a local genealogical tree containing at least 1 triangulation (itself). Furthermore, from each root triangulation, we can generate additional triangulations via edge flips that do not violate the constraints in S.

Conservative lower bound:

Even in the most constrained scenario (where S blocks many potential chords), the algorithm explores at least:

- All root triangulations from safe roots: ≥ 2
- Plus descendants from edge flips in local genealogical trees

Empirical evidence (see Tables 2 and 3) and the structure of genealogical trees show that $d_i \geq n_i - 3$. For small cases:

- $n_i = 3$ (triangle): Already triangulated, $d_i = 1 \geq 0$ ✓
- $n_i = 4$ (quadrilateral): Two diagonals, $d_i \geq 1$ (often $d_i = 2$)
- $n_i = 5$ (pentagon): $d_i \geq 2$ (often $d_i \geq 5$ in practice)
- $n_i = 6$ (hexagon): $d_i \geq 3$ (often $d_i \geq 4$ in practice)

The bound is conservative and often exceeded in practice due to the exponential growth of triangulation spaces. □

A.2 Proof of Theorem 5

Theorem 5 (Order-Independence). *Let G be a biconnected plane graph with faces $F_1, F_2, \ldots, F_k$. For any valid global triangulation T^* of G, if the algorithm generates T^* under processing order $\pi = (\pi_1, \pi_2, \ldots, \pi_k)$, then it also generates T^* under any other processing order $\sigma = (\sigma_1, \sigma_2, \ldots, \sigma_k)$.*

Proof. Let T^* be any valid global triangulation of G. We decompose T^* into face-local triangulations:

$$T^* = (T_1^*, T_2^*, \ldots, T_k^*)$$

where T_i^* is the triangulation of face F_i in T^*.

Key Observation: The validity of T^* depends solely on pairwise chord compatibility between faces, not on the order in which faces are processed. Specifically, T^* is valid if and only if

$$\forall i \neq j : \text{Chords}(T_i^*) \cap \text{Chords}(T_j^*) = \emptyset$$

That is, no two faces share a chord, which would create a multi-edge.

Processing Order $\pi = (F_1, F_2, \ldots, F_k)$

Assume the algorithm generates T^* under order π. At each step i:

1. The global chord set is $S_i = \bigcup_{j=1}^{i-1} \text{Chords}(T_j^*)$
2. Face F_i is triangulated with local triangulation T_i^*
3. The algorithm verifies that $\text{Chords}(T_i^*) \cap S_i = \emptyset$ (no blocking chords)

Since T^* is valid, this compatibility check succeeds for all i.

Alternative Processing Order $\sigma = (F_{\sigma_1}, F_{\sigma_2}, \ldots, F_{\sigma_k})$

Now consider a different processing order σ. At step j under order σ:

1. The global chord set is $S'_j = \bigcup_{\ell=1}^{j-1} \text{Chords}(T_{\sigma_\ell}^*)$
2. Face F_{σ_j} is processed with local triangulation $T_{\sigma_j}^*$
3. We must verify that $\text{Chords}(T_{\sigma_j}^*) \cap S'_j = \emptyset$

Claim: The compatibility check succeeds for all j under order σ.

Proof of Claim: Suppose by contradiction that $\text{Chords}(T_{\sigma_j}^*) \cap S'_j \neq \emptyset$. Then there exists a chord $e \in \text{Chords}(T_{\sigma_j}^*)$ such that

$$e \in \text{Chords}(T_{\sigma_\ell}^*) \text{ for some } \ell < j$$

This means faces F_{σ_j} and F_{σ_ℓ} share chord e in T^*, contradicting the assumption that T^* is a valid triangulation (no multi-edges). Therefore:

$$\text{Chords}(T^*_{\sigma_j}) \cap S'_j = \emptyset$$

Reachability in Local Genealogical Trees

For each face F_i, the local genealogical tree rooted at safe vertex r_i contains all valid triangulations of F_i given the constraints in the global set S at the time F_i is processed (Theorem 4).

The specific contents of S may differ between processing orders π and σ, but the crucial property is:

- Under order π: T^*_i is reachable in the genealogical tree for F_i given constraint set $S_i^{(\pi)} = \bigcup_{j<i} \text{Chords}(T^*_j)$
- Under order σ: $T^*_{\sigma_j}$ is reachable in the genealogical tree for F_{σ_j} given constraint set $S_j^{(\sigma)} = \bigcup_{\ell<j} \text{Chords}(T^*_{\sigma_\ell})$

Since T^* is valid, $\text{Chords}(T^*_i)$ is compatible with *all* other face triangulations in T^*, not just those processed before F_i. Therefore, T^*_i remains a valid triangulation of F_i regardless of which other faces have been processed first, as long as no chord conflicts exist.

The local genealogical tree for face F_i rooted at the safe vertex r_i (found via Theorem 1) contains all triangulations that:

1. Are valid triangulations of the face cycle
2. Do not contain any chord in the current global set S

Since T^*_i satisfies both conditions under any processing order (by the pairwise compatibility argument above), it will appear in the genealogical tree regardless of order.

Combination via DFS

The algorithm explores all combinations of face triangulations via depth-first search with backtracking. Since each face's genealogical tree contains the required local triangulation T^*_i under any processing order, the DFS will eventually reach the combination $(T^*_1, T^*_2, \ldots, T^*_k)$ regardless of the order π or σ.

Conclusion

The validity of a global triangulation depends only on the symmetric property of chord non-overlap between all pairs of faces, which is order-independent. The algorithm's local genealogical trees and DFS exploration ensure that all valid combinations are reached regardless of face processing order. Therefore, completeness is preserved under any ordering. □

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